

NEW USER GUIDE · IGNITE_APEX SALES OS



You have a system now. Here is how to use it.

SALES OPERATING SYSTEM · COMPLETE WALKTHROUGH

This guide walks you through every screen, every question, every button — and more importantly, *why* each one exists. By the end, you will not just know how to use IGNITE_APEX. You will understand why the sequence is designed the way it is, and you will be a better salesperson because of it.

"Most sales processes fail because reps skip the diagnosis and jump to the pitch. This system makes skipping impossible — and that is not a constraint. It is the competitive advantage."

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BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Getting Started – Register & First Login

You access the system at shaamelz.com/app. Before you can use it, you need to register. Registration takes 60 seconds and requires an invite code from your admin.

WHAT TO DO

- 1 Go to shaamelz.com/app and click the **Register** tab
- 2 Enter your **Full Name**, **Email**, and a **Password** (minimum 6 characters). You will use these to sign in every time.
- 3 Enter your **Invite Code** — this is provided by your admin. It looks like [APEX7K3X2Q](#). Enter it exactly as given.
- 4 Click **Create Account & Start Free Trial**. You are in. Your 30-day free trial starts now.

WHY THERE IS AN INVITE CODE

This is not a public tool. Each user receives a personalised invite code. This ensures that every person using the system is a known, vetted user — and that your sales intelligence stays within your organisation.



Your data lives in your browser. Everything you type into the system is saved locally — it persists between sessions on the same device and browser. Do not clear your browser storage or switch devices mid-deal if you want your data to remain intact. Use the same browser, same device, consistently.

AFTER YOUR 30-DAY TRIAL

The system will lock and ask for a **Licence Key**. Contact your admin to subscribe (USD 4.50/user/month). They will issue you a key like [IA-2026-YOURNAME-XXXX](#). Enter it once — the app unlocks permanently for your account.

THE BIG PICTURE

Why This Sequence Exists — and Why You Cannot Skip It

Before you open a single deal, you need to understand why IGNITE_APEX is built the way it is. Most sales reps fail not because they lack skill — they fail because they apply skill in the wrong order, on the wrong prospects, with the wrong foundation. This system fixes all three.



IGNITE → ATTRACT → PROBE → EXECUTE → EXCEL → CEMENT → REPORT

THE CORE PRINCIPLE YOU MUST INTERNALISE

In a demand generation market — where prospects do not yet know they need your solution — demand must be *created* before anything can be *sold*. If you try to qualify before demand exists, you waste time. If you try to close before the root cause is diagnosed, you lose the deal. If you forecast before the qualification gates are passed, you inflate your pipeline and lose your manager's trust. The sequence is not bureaucracy. It is the architecture that prevents all three failure modes simultaneously.

What each stage actually does

STAGE	WHAT IT CREATES	WHAT HAPPENS WITHOUT IT
IGNITE	The conditions for a real conversation — trigger, research, opener, outreach, nurture, escalation	You contact the wrong person at the wrong time with a generic message. You get ignored or permanently blacklisted.
ATTRACT	Confirmation that demand exists and the prospect fits your ICP	You invest 3 months on a prospect who was never going to buy. You call it a loss. It was a disqualification failure.
PROBE	The root cause diagnosis — the moment the deal is effectively closed	You pitch features. The prospect nods politely. They buy nothing or buy a competitor who understood their problem better than you did.
EXECUTE	A forecast you can actually defend — 20 questions that strip out wishful thinking	You commit deals that slip. Your pipeline is phantom. Your forecast credibility collapses. Your manager stops trusting your numbers.
EXCEL	The mental and physical operating system of a high-performance rep	Skills without mindset produce inconsistent results. You close well when you feel good. You miss when you are under pressure. The system becomes unreliable.
CEMENT	5-year client stickiness — expansion revenue at 5–7× lower cost than new logos	You close the deal and disappear. The relationship is vendor-level. They churn at renewal. Or a competitor

STAGE	WHAT IT CREATES	WHAT HAPPENS WITHOUT IT
		displaces you in year 2 because you never became strategic.



One deal at a time. The system is designed for one specific deal with one specific prospect. Every time you start a new deal, enter the prospect name in the top bar and work through the stages fresh. Your configuration (product, ICP, 4U framework) is set once and powers every deal — the discovery questions, scripts, and competitive battlecard all adapt to your specific product automatically.



STAGE 1 OF 6 · S1 THROUGH S7

IGNITE – Six Stages Before You Contact Anyone

IGNITE is not a mindset warm-up. It is a 6-stage operating system that builds the foundation for every interaction with a prospect. You complete these stages *before* you make contact — not during. Think of it as your preparation architecture.

WHY IGNITE EXISTS AND WHY IT COMES FIRST

In most sales processes, reps contact prospects as soon as they have a name and a phone number. This is the single biggest destroyer of pipeline quality. An untimely, generic contact does not just fail — it permanently closes the door. Prospects who receive a poorly timed or poorly researched outreach categorise you as irrelevant, and that label is almost impossible to remove. IGNITE forces you to earn the right to make contact before you make it.

Stage 1-1 – Identify: Right Prospect, Right Moment

S1-S2 · The trigger test

Before you write a single word to a prospect, you must answer one question: **why now?** Not why this prospect — why this prospect, *at this specific moment in time*. A trigger event is something that has changed in their world that makes your solution relevant today in a way it was not 3 months ago.

WHAT TO DO

- 1 Tick both mindset checkboxes: **Missionary over Mercenary** and **ICP Confirmed Before First Contact**. These are not formalities — read them carefully. If you cannot honestly tick them, you are not ready.

- 2 In the trigger field, write the specific event that makes right now the right moment. Minimum 30 characters — a keyword is not enough. Examples: "Government mandated compliance deadline Q1 2026," "New CEO announced digitisation as strategic priority in annual report," "Key competitor just launched a competing product." Be specific.
- 3 Click ✓ **Clear trigger identified — timing is justified** to confirm this stage.



IF YOU CLICK THE RED BUTTON (NO TRIGGER YET)

The system blocks your progress and shows a warning. This is intentional. You should not contact this prospect until a trigger exists. Set a reminder. Watch for one of these: leadership change, competitor announcement, regulatory update, budget cycle opening, public strategic pivot, failed initiative announcement. When a trigger occurs, return and confirm this stage. Contacting without a trigger wastes your access to this prospect — permanently.

WHAT THE SYSTEM DOES WHEN YOU CONFIRM

The badge in the stage header changes from "Not started" to "✓ Complete" in green. The master gate at the top of the page updates to show you are on Stage G. The page automatically scrolls to Stage G after 700ms.

Stage G – Go Deep: Know Their World Before You Enter It

S3 · Research before contact

You have 15 minutes before any first contact. In those 15 minutes, you must be able to answer four questions without notes. If you cannot, you are not ready. Generic outreach does not just fail — it permanently destroys future access by signalling that you do not respect the prospect's time.

WHAT TO FILL IN

- 1 **Their strategic priorities:** What is this organisation trying to achieve in the next 12–18 months? Read their annual report, CEO statements, LinkedIn posts from leadership, recent press releases. Write it in your own words.
- 2 **The individual you are contacting:** What is their mandate? What are their likely KPIs? What would their professional life look like if they solved the problem you solve? What have they written or said publicly?
- 3 **Competitive pressure on them:** What has a competitor done recently that is putting pressure on this organisation? Market shifts, new entrants, technology changes? This context makes your outreach feel like you understand their world — not just your product.
- 4 **Peer reference / after-state:** What does a similar organisation look like after solving the problem you solve? A specific case study, a named example, a measurable outcome. This becomes your most powerful social proof.

WHY RESEARCH BEFORE CONTACT MATTERS THIS MUCH

The first message you send creates a permanent category in the prospect's mind. Either: "this person understands my world" — or "this is a sales call." The first category earns a response. The second earns a block. Research is what creates the first category. It takes 15 minutes. It determines whether you get access at all.



N Stage N – Nail the Insight: The Reframe Opener

S4 · The first sentence that earns the conversation

Your opener is the first thing your prospect reads. It must do one thing: make them think "I hadn't considered that." It must do this *without mentioning your product*. The test: could they guess what you sell from your opener? If yes — rewrite it.

WHAT TO DO

- 1 Tick "**Education as Primary Weapon**." Confirm you can explain the value of your category in 90 seconds without naming your product. This is a real skill check — not a checkbox.
- 2 Write your **Reframe Opener** (minimum 40 characters — must be a complete sentence). Write about their world, not your product. Lead with a non-obvious insight: a consequence they have not fully mapped, a trend they are underestimating, a risk their competitor is exploiting that they are not.
- 3 Choose your **Entry Point** from the 5 options shown on screen and explain why it fits this specific prospect's context. The 5 options are: Insight-Led Opening, Peer Reference Trigger, 24-Month Consequence, Low-Commitment Entry, Warm Signal Response.

WHY 5 ENTRY POINTS — NOT JUST ONE

Different prospects are in different stages of awareness. Some need a peer reference because they trust social proof over insight. Some are ready for a consequence picture because they have been sitting with the pain for years. Some need a low-commitment entry because they are risk-averse. Choosing the right entry point for this specific prospect is what separates a response from a non-response. Read the descriptions of each one carefully. The choice matters.

I Stage I-2 – Initiate: The 9-Day Outreach Sequence

S5 · Structured, not spammy

The 9-day sequence shown on screen is not arbitrary. It is built on the principle that demand generation selling requires multiple touches, each delivering value, each slightly more specific than the last — before

any commercial ask. Follow it exactly.

THE SEQUENCE

- D1** **LinkedIn connection + your reframe opener.** One sentence. Their world. No product. No pitch. No "I'd love to connect."
- D3** **Value touch — no ask.** Share something useful: an article, a framework, a relevant insight. Comment on something they posted. This is a credibility deposit. Zero commercial intent.
- D5** **Peer reference email.** "I was just working with [similar org] and they discovered something about [consequence] that I think applies to your situation. Would a 15-minute call be worth exploring?"
- D7** **Consequence picture.** One short paragraph showing the 24-month trajectory if nothing changes. No product mention. End with: "I am happy to share what others in your position have found useful — no commitment."
- D9** **The permission close.** "I have reached out a few times. If this is not relevant, please say so and I will stop. If there is any chance it could be, 15 minutes is all I am asking for." Then stop. Silence is your last message.



WHY STOP AFTER DAY 9?

A prospect who has not responded after 5 structured touches has not rejected you — they have not yet reached the conviction threshold. Continuing to push after Day 9 crosses from persistent to pestering. Move them to a 30-day nurture cadence (one value touch per month). They will re-engage when their context changes. Your job is to still be visible and credible when that happens.

T Stage T – Track & Nurture: The Relationship Phase

S6 · Watching for the conviction signal

Most prospects in a demand generation market are not ready to buy when you first contact them. They become ready over time — as their context shifts and your credibility builds. Track that process. Log every signal. Give unconditional value. Wait for the threshold.

WHAT TO LOG IN STAGE T

- 1** **Buying signals observed:** Any unprompted engagement — they liked your post, replied to your email with a question, mentioned your name to a colleague, attended your webinar. Log every one with the date and exact context.
- 2** **Value given with no commercial ask:** Articles shared, introductions made, frameworks sent, events invited to. For every commercial conversation you want, you must have made at least 3 deposits first. Log them.

On screen you will see **6 Conviction Threshold Indicators**. These are the signals that tell you it is time to escalate. Watch for them. They include: they reference your content in conversation, they ask a commercial question unprompted, they forward your message to a colleague, they contact you without a prompt. When one fires, move to Stage E *within 48 hours*.



E Stage E – Escalate: From Education to Active Engagement

S7 · The final IGNITE gate

You have earned the right to make a commercial ask. Not a sales meeting. A *diagnostic conversation*. The framing matters enormously. Read the escalation script on screen — it is designed to lower the perceived risk of saying yes.

WHAT TO FILL IN AND CONFIRM

- 1 In the escalation status field, write: which conviction signal you observed (exact words, date), the escalation ask you made (exact wording), and the prospect's response.
- 2 Click ✓ **Conviction signal observed — escalation made — ready for ATTRACT** to complete all 6 IGNITE stages. The master gate turns green. You may now advance to ATTRACT.

IF YOU CLICK RED (STILL IN NURTURE PHASE)

No conviction signal has been observed yet. Do not escalate. Escalating without a signal resets the relationship to cold — you introduce commercial intent before the prospect has mentally crossed the threshold, and they disengage. Return to Stage T. Continue the nurture cadence. One signal is enough. Wait for it.

STAGE 2 · GATE 1

ATTRACT – Qualify or Walk Away

ATTRACT has two layers. First you check whether real demand exists (Tier 1 Gate). Then you score the fit (ICP Matrix). Both must pass before you invest another hour of your time.

WHY QUALIFY THIS EARLY — AND THIS HARD?

The most expensive thing in sales is not the lost deal — it is the time spent on the wrong prospect. A rep who spends 3 months on a prospect who was never going to buy has not just lost one deal. They have lost

the 3 months of pipeline they could have built on real opportunities. ATTRACT exists to make that choice at hour 2, not month 3.

Layer 1: Tier 1 Demand Gate — 5 questions, minimum 4/5 to proceed

These 5 questions are personalised to your product. Every question uses your specific ICP, your specific problem statement, and your specific competitive context — not generic language. Answer each one with verifiable evidence.



Q	WHAT YOU ARE TESTING	WHAT COUNTS AS EVIDENCE
T1 • 1	Conviction vs complaint. Have they expressed that the current situation fundamentally cannot continue — not just that it is painful?	A direct quote from the prospect saying something equivalent to "this cannot go on" — not just "yes, we have that problem."
T1 • 2	24-month consequence cascade. Map 3 layers: operational damage, strategic exposure, competitive loss.	Layer 3 must be a competitive consequence — what a rival gains from the gap they are creating. If you cannot name the rival and the gain, you have not gone deep enough.
T1 • 3	Prior attempt audit. What did they try before, and why did it specifically fail?	Name the tool, vendor, or initiative — and the real reason it did not stick. "Too expensive" is not a real reason. "Wrong stakeholder sponsored it" is a real reason.
T1 • 4	Unprompted commercial signals. List every commercial signal they gave you without you introducing the topic first.	They asked about pricing, timelines, contract terms, or deployment without you prompting. One real signal is worth more than ten enthusiastic meetings.
T1 • 5	Personal stake. Name the individual whose personal targets, credibility, or career is damaged if this problem stays unsolved.	A name, a role, and a specific personal consequence. "The IT department" is not an answer. "James, VP Operations, whose digital transformation KPI is at risk" is an answer.

IF THE DEMAND GATE FAILS (BELOW 4/5)

The system shows "DEMAND GATE FAILED." This prospect is not yet a qualified opportunity. The demand conditions that make buying possible are not in place. Do not advance to ICP scoring. Return to IGNITE and identify which conditions are missing. Usually it is T1:1 (complaint, not conviction) or T1:4 (no organic commercial signals). Build toward those before returning.

Layer 2: ICP Scoring Matrix — minimum 70/100 to proceed

Five criteria, each scored 0–20. Use the dropdown selectors on screen. The score updates live. Be honest — this is not a box-ticking exercise. A score below 70 means you should walk away from this prospect and invest your time in one with higher fit.

Budget Authority

Pain Intensity

Strategic Fit

Timeline to Decision

Competitor Exposure



Score 70 is the floor, not the target. A score of 70–79 means proceed with caution — you have a qualified prospect but not an ideal one. A score of 90+ means you have found exactly who this solution is built for. Your highest-probability deals come from prospects scoring 85+. Prioritise accordingly.



STAGE 3 · GATE 2 · THE MOST IMPORTANT STAGE

PROBE – 70% of the Sale Happens Here

If IGNITE built the conditions and ATTRACT confirmed the fit, PROBE is where you actually win the deal — before you present anything. The deal is effectively closed the moment your prospect names the root cause in their own words at Layer 3. Everything after that is execution.

WHY 70% OF THE SALE HAPPENS IN DIAGNOSIS

Most reps rush through discovery to get to the pitch. This is backwards. Prospects do not buy solutions — they buy the feeling that someone finally understood their problem accurately. A prospect who says "that is exactly what I have been trying to explain" is a prospect who has mentally already decided to buy. That moment happens in PROBE. Not in the proposal. Not in the demo. In the diagnosis.

Part 1 — The 3-Layer Root Cause Diagnostic

Three text fields. Work through them during your discovery conversation — in real time or immediately after. The quality of what you write here determines the quality of everything downstream: the proposal, the scripts, the report.

WHAT TO CAPTURE IN EACH LAYER

- L1 Layer 1 — Symptom (their exact words).** What do they describe as the problem? Do not summarise. Do not interpret. Copy their exact language. The words they use are your proposal language. "Our teams are spending 3 hours a day on manual data entry" is Layer 1. Write it exactly as they said it.
- L2 Layer 2 — Structural Cause.** What process, system, or organisational structure is creating the symptom? Ask: "And what do you think is behind that?" Push past the first answer. The structural cause is usually a broken process or absent capability — not a technology gap.
- L3 Layer 3 — Root Cause ★ (the most important field in the entire system).** This is the moment when the prospect names, in their own words, the fundamental reason their current approach cannot solve the problem. Ask: "If we trace this back to the root — what do you think is the real reason this has not been solved yet?" When they answer without prompting, write their exact words. This sentence goes into your proposal, your scripts, and your report. It is the anchor of the entire deal.

WHY LAYER 3 MUST BE IN THEIR WORDS, NOT YOURS

When a prospect hears their own words reflected back in a proposal, they do not experience it as sales. They experience it as understanding. That difference is the difference between a prospect who defends your proposal internally with conviction and one who forwards it for comment. You do not write Layer 3. You transcribe it.

**Part 2 — Pain → Impact → ROI Ladder**

Three more fields. These are quantification fields — moving from the story to the number.

WHAT TO CAPTURE

Pain **What is broken?** In their exact words. The specific operational problem causing daily friction. This should come directly from Layer 1 or 2.

Impact **What does it cost?** Quantified. Time lost, revenue missed, errors incurred, staff hours wasted. Ask: "If you tried to put a number on what this costs you monthly — what would that be?" A rough number they are comfortable defending is more valuable than a precise number they are not sure about. The system uses this number to calculate ROI in your scripts.

ROI **What is it worth to fix?** Agreed value in year one. Ask: "If we solve this completely, what would that be worth to you in the first 12 months?" This is the number that goes into your ROI close. It must be a figure they stated — not one you calculated for them.

Part 3 — Champion vs. Sponsor Test

Two people you must identify in every deal. Confusing them is one of the most common reasons deals stall.

WHO TO IDENTIFY AND WHAT TO CAPTURE

 **Champion (name + role):** The person who will spend their own political capital to get this deal approved. They are not just enthusiastic — they actively do things that cost them something. Test: ask them to arrange an introduction to the economic buyer. A sponsor says "sure, I'll pass along your details." A champion says "let me set up a meeting — what time works for you?" Log the most recent internal meeting they briefed you on, with specific names and reactions from that meeting.

 **Veto Player (name + role):** The most sceptical stakeholder. They may not be involved yet — but they will be consulted before approval. Log their specific concern and what action you have taken (or planned) to address it directly.



The champion test question. "If I needed 20 minutes with [economic buyer], could you make that happen?" Their response tells you everything. Immediate yes with a specific next step = champion. Vague maybe = sponsor. "I don't really have that access" = you have the wrong person and your deal is at risk.

STAGE 4 • GATE 3 • 20 QUESTIONS

EXECUTE – Twenty Questions That Protect Your Forecast

EXECUTE is the most rigorous gate in the system. By the time you reach here, the demand exists, the prospect fits, and the root cause is diagnosed. Now you must answer a harder question: is this deal real enough to belong in your forecast? 

WHY 20 QUESTIONS — AND WHY THIS MANY?

The average sales rep has 60–70% forecast accuracy. Meaning roughly 1 in 3 deals they commit, they miss. Almost always, the root cause is the same: they answered questions with optimism rather than evidence. These 20 questions — across 3 tiers — are designed to make that impossible. You cannot confirm a question without writing down verifiable evidence. If you cannot write it, you do not have it. If you do not have it, the deal does not belong in your forecast.

Click any question header to expand it. Write your evidence in the text area first. Then click the confirm or fail button. The status badge on the right of each question updates immediately to show Confirmed or Not Confirmed.

Tier 2 — Opportunity Qualifier (10 questions)

These 10 questions determine whether this opportunity deserves to exist in your pipeline at all. Answer them in any order, but answer all 10.

Q	WHAT IT TESTS	WHAT EVIDENCE LOOKS LIKE
1	Economic Buyer named and directly engaged	Name, role, the date you last spoke directly, what they said. "I heard through my champion" does not count.
2	Prospect has invested something irrecoverable	They assembled an eval team, ran a pilot, presented internally, allocated budget. Something that costs them if they walk away.
3	Hard external forcing event with a specific date	Regulatory deadline, contract expiry, budget cycle close, board review. The date must be external — not the date you want to close.
4	Real objection surfaced — not just enthusiasm	The hesitation they have not fully voiced. A prospect who has never expressed concern is observing, not evaluating. Find the real concern and name it.
5	Deal survives if champion leaves	Evidence the business case is institutional — documented, multi-stakeholder endorsed. If it dies with your champion, it is not a company deal yet.
6	Decision criteria explicitly stated by prospect	Their exact words on what will make this a yes — in priority order. If you are inferring criteria, you are guessing what winning looks like.

Q	WHAT IT TESTS	WHAT EVIDENCE LOOKS LIKE
7	Structural change in last 90 days	Leadership change, competitor move, failed initiative, strategic pivot. Something that turned urgency from gradual to event-driven.
8	Full competitive landscape including do-nothing	Named competitors + the real alternatives: delay, build internally, do nothing. The most common competitor is inaction — map it.
9	Paper process fully mapped	Every approval step, every person, every legal or compliance review, and the realistic time from verbal yes to signed PO. Not the best case — the realistic case.
10	The \$10,000 Bet	Would you stake your own money on this closing in your stated period? Immediate yes = commit candidate. Hesitation = the hesitation is your real answer.



Tier 3 — Forecast Commit Gate (5 questions — unlocks when T2 ≥ 5/10)

The Tier 3 section is hidden until you have answered all 10 Tier 2 questions and scored at least 5. When it appears, answer all 5. All 5 must pass for a COMMIT verdict. These are the non-negotiable gates.

Q	WHAT IT TESTS	WHAT COUNTS AS EVIDENCE
T3•1	Unprompted commercial language	Quote their exact words — pricing, start date, contract length, implementation resources — raised by them, not by you.
T3•2	Internal meeting intelligence	Your champion debriefed you with the names of who was in the meeting and their specific reactions. Not a summary — actual names and actual responses.
T3•3	Multi-stakeholder validation	Substantive commercial or technical conversation with a minimum of 2 people beyond your primary contact. Named, with dates and subject of conversation.
T3•4	Kill risk named with mitigation	The one thing that could still kill this deal — named specifically. And the concrete action already in motion to mitigate it.
T3•5	Slip cause pre-diagnosed	If this does not close this month — the real reason. Not the official reason. And the specific action you are taking right now to prevent it.



The Closing Technique and Objection Handler are also in EXECUTE, above the qualification questions. Before your closing conversation, select the technique that fits the current state of the deal. Before handling an objection, select the objection they raised — the system generates a counter-question script based on the objection type. Use these tools before your next conversation, not during it.

EXCEL – The Daily Rep Operating System

EXCEL is the only stage in the system that is not about a specific deal. It is about you — the rep who runs every deal. Skills get you to average. Mindset multiplies everything. EXCEL is the multiplier.



WHY A MINDSET STAGE EXISTS INSIDE A SALES QUALIFICATION SYSTEM

Demand generation selling is psychologically harder than transactional selling. You face more rejections, longer cycles, and more prospects who do not yet know they have a problem. Without a deliberate system for managing that pressure, the best reps become inconsistent — closing well in good weeks, disappearing in bad ones. EXCEL is the system that makes performance consistent regardless of external conditions.

WHAT TO DO — DAILY

- 1 **Complete the Peak Performance Ritual.** Five checkboxes. Tick each one as you complete it. When all 5 are ticked, EXCEL marks as complete for this session. These are not suggestions — they are the operational prerequisites for consistent performance.
- 2 **Review the Rejection Resilience Protocol** any time you face a difficult interaction. Read it before a high-stakes call. Read it after a rejection. It reframes the early-stage silence and objections that are structural to demand generation — not personal to you.

STAGE 6 • POST-SALE • MONTHS 1-36+

CEMENT – The Post-Sale Architecture

The close is the starting gun, not the finish line. Every action you took before the close was done with a 5-year horizon in mind. CEMENT is where you execute on that horizon. It is also where your next deal inside this account comes from.

WHY CEMENT IS PART OF THE SALES SYSTEM — NOT THE CUSTOMER SUCCESS SYSTEM

Expansion revenue costs 5–7 times less to generate than new logo revenue. The rep who plans CEMENT from the first discovery call — not after the contract is signed — is the rep who grows accounts. CEMENT is not customer success. Customer success reacts to problems. CEMENT engineers the conditions that make displacement impossible and expansion inevitable. It starts on Day 1 of implementation.

The 5 Layers — work through them over time

TICK EACH ACTION AS YOU COMPLETE IT — THE CEMENT SCORE UPDATES LIVE

- 1-3 Layer 1 — Outcome Ownership (Month 1-3):** Schedule 30/60/90-day check-ins. Build your QBR template around the exact root cause you diagnosed in PROBE — reference their words. Surface one implementation risk before it becomes visible to them. This is the moment you transition from vendor to strategic partner.
- 3-9 Layer 2 — Stakeholder Expansion (Month 3-9):** Identify 3 stakeholders beyond your primary contact — at different levels. Deliver individual value to each. If your primary contact leaves tomorrow, can the deal survive? The answer should be yes.
- 6-18 Layer 3 — Institutional Knowledge (Month 6-18):** Maintain a living document updated after every interaction — their cycles, their politics, their strategic priorities, their prior failures. Reference it in every new conversation. You remember what they forget. That is a moat no new vendor can cross in 6 months.
- 12-24 Layer 4 — Root Cause Chain Expansion (Month 12-24):** Solving the first root cause reveals the next one. Document it. Frame the expansion as a natural next step in *their* journey — not as a new sales motion. They should feel like they proposed it.
- 18-36+ Layer 5 — Advocacy Engineering (Month 18-36+):** Co-create a case study. Get a peer referral. Do a joint presentation or speaking engagement. When a client has invested their credibility publicly in your solution — they cannot easily leave. This is the deepest form of stickiness available.



THE CEMENT SCORE WIDGET

At the bottom of the CEMENT page, a live score widget shows your current percentage (0-100%), the fraction of actions completed (e.g. 7/16), a colour-coded progress bar, and a mini-bar for each of the 5 layers. This score feeds into the report cover and Section 6 of the report. You do not need to reach 100% to generate a report — generate it at any completion level and the report will flag which layers need attention.

SYSTEM OUTPUT

The Report — Your Deal Briefing PDF

Click **Download Report Briefing** at the bottom of the CEMENT page. The report opens in a new tab and pulls together everything you captured across all 6 stages into a 9-section printable briefing document.

WHY THE REPORT EXISTS AND WHEN TO USE IT

The report serves three purposes: (1) a self-audit — reading it forces you to confront any gaps in your deal intelligence before they surface in a forecast review; (2) a briefing for your manager or team — everything

about the deal in one document, no guessing; (3) a preparation tool for your next conversation — the scripts in Section 8 are generated from your specific inputs and are ready to use.

What is in each section



SECTION	WHAT IT CONTAINS AND WHY IT MATTERS
1 — Executive Summary	4 KPI boxes (IGNITE completion, probe layers, T2 score, CEMENT score) + one-line verdict on forecast status, ICP gate, and root cause capture. Read this first. If it shows gaps, address them before the forecast meeting.
2 — IGNITE Record	Table of all 6 IGNITE stages with status and evidence. If any stage shows "Not confirmed," you have incomplete demand creation work that will surface as a problem later.
3 — ATTRACT ICP	Your 5-criterion ICP score with per-criterion assessment. A score below 70 that made it to this stage is a flag — review why this prospect was advanced.
4 — PROBE Diagnosis	All 3 root cause layers, Pain/Impact/ROI, Champion and Veto intelligence. The quality of this section predicts the quality of your proposal and scripts.
5 — Qualification System	All 20 questions (T1+T2+T3) with your answers and evidence. Master verdict at the top. This is the section your manager needs to see to trust your forecast number.
6 — CEMENT Score	Layer-by-layer progress with completed and incomplete actions. A low score here is not a failure — it is a roadmap. Use it to plan the next 3 months of account activity.
7 — Recommendations	Every missing or weak input generates a specific, stage-labelled recommendation. Read this every time you generate a report. These are the gaps that will cost you the deal if not addressed.
8 — Next Step Scripts	10 scripts across 5 situations — 2 per situation. All generated from your captured data. No [X] or [Y] placeholders. The system extracts numbers from your impact text, computes annual loss and ROI multiple, and writes complete sentences. These are ready to use verbatim or adapt to your voice.
9 — PPT Slide Layouts	6 suggested slides for your next review or client presentation, pre-populated with your deal data. Use as a starting structure for any internal or external presentation.

TO SAVE AS PDF

- 1 In the report tab, click **Print / Save as PDF** at the bottom of the page.
- 2 In the print dialog: change the destination to "**Save as PDF**". The report is formatted for A4/Letter with page breaks between sections.

REFERENCE

Understanding Your Verdict — What Each Result Means



The system produces verdicts at three levels: the IGNITE Gate, the Tier 1 Demand Gate, and the Master Qualification Verdict. Here is exactly what each one means and what you must do in response.

IGNITE Gate (top of IGNITE page)

WHAT IT SHOWS	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT TO DO
✓ IGNITE Complete	All 6 stages confirmed. Demand creation work is done.	Advance to ATTRACT.
⊖ Stage [X] Blocked	A specific stage returned a red answer.	Read the consequence message for that stage. Address the specific issue it describes. Do not advance until resolved.
→ Current Stage: [Name]	You are still working through the stages.	Complete the named stage and confirm it before moving forward.

Tier 1 Demand Gate (ATTRACT page)

RESULT	MEANING	ACTION
✓ Gate Passed (4+/5)	Real demand established. Proceed.	Complete the ICP Scoring Matrix.
✗ Gate Failed (below 4/5)	Demand conditions are not met. Not a qualified opportunity.	Return to IGNITE. Identify which of the 5 conditions is missing. Build toward it. Do not advance.

Master Qualification Verdict (bottom of EXECUTE page and in report)

VERDICT	SCORE THRESHOLD	WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOUR FORECAST
DISQUALIFIED	T1 below 4/5	Not in pipeline. Do not include in any report. Return to IGNITE and address demand conditions first.
PIPELINE ONLY	T2 below 5/10	Too little evidence. Include as a name on your prospect list only. Do not include in any forecast conversation. Return to PROBE — you need more qualification work.

VERDICT	SCORE THRESHOLD	WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOUR FORECAST
PIPELINE+	T2: 5–6/10	Qualifies as active pipeline. Not yet best case. Identify which T2 criteria are missing and address them in your next 1–2 interactions.
BEST CASE	T2: 7–9/10 or T3 incomplete	Include in best case forecast. Complete Tier 3 — all 5 questions — for commit eligibility. Do not call this a commit until T3 is fully passed. 
COMMIT FORECAST	T1: 4+/5 · T2: 10/10 · T3: 5/5	This deal has survived every qualification gate. It belongs in your commit number. If you commit something that has not reached this threshold, you are adding phantom pipeline. The system will not stop you — but the missed forecast will.

CRITICAL

Rules of the System – What You Must Never Do

The system is built on discipline. These rules are not suggestions. Each one exists because breaking it has a specific, predictable consequence.

NEVER CONTACT A PROSPECT BEFORE STAGE 1-1 IS CONFIRMED

A prospect contacted without a trigger is a prospect you reached on a random Tuesday. They will file you as irrelevant. You will not get a second chance to be relevant. Wait for the trigger. It will come.

NEVER ADVANCE PAST TIER 1 GATE FAILURE

A failed Demand Gate means the conditions for buying do not yet exist. Advancing anyway means you are investing qualification time in a prospect who cannot buy — not one who will not. The difference matters. One requires more demand creation work. The other requires disqualification.

NEVER WRITE LAYER 3 IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Layer 3 must be the prospect's exact words. If you paraphrase it, your proposal uses your language, not theirs. A prospect who reads a proposal in your language experiences it as a sales document. A prospect who reads their own words reflected back experiences it as understanding. The difference determines whether they defend your proposal internally or send it "for review."

NEVER COMMIT A DEAL THAT HAS NOT PASSED ALL 3 TIER 3 GATES

A commit that slips is not just a missed number. It erodes your forecast credibility with your manager — and credibility, once lost, takes quarters to rebuild. The 5 Tier 3 gates exist specifically to prevent commits that will

slip. Use them.

NEVER SKIP CEMENT BECAUSE THE DEAL IS CLOSED

The deal being closed is the reason to start CEMENT — not to skip it. The 5 layers of CEMENT are what turn a closed deal into a 3-year account. Without them, you will spend the same energy re-acquiring this account at year 2 renewal that you spent acquiring it in year 1. CEMENT is the return on that original investment.



THE SYSTEM WORKS BECAUSE OF ITS CONSTRAINTS — NOT IN SPITE OF THEM

Every validation, every minimum character count, every required field, every gate — they all exist because the data shows what happens when those constraints are removed: reps over-forecast, prospects are contacted too early, deals are lost in qualification gaps that were visible in advance. The discipline is the competitive advantage. Use the system as it is designed. Do not shortcut it. The constraints are the product.

IGNITE_APEX Sales Operating System · New User Guide

Work one deal at a time. Work each stage in full. Trust the sequence.

"Qualifies harder than anyone. Diagnoses deeper than anyone. Reads what is never said. Forecasts with brutal honesty. Closes fast because conviction was already built. Then spends the next five years making themselves impossible to replace."